

Regular Meeting
Monday, November 05, 2018
Medford School Committee
Council Chambers

Present: Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mr. Ruggiero, Mayor Burke, Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent, Associate Superintendent Ms. Caldwell, Assistant Superintendent of Finance Ms. Patterson, and High School Representative Jasper Su.

The regular meeting of the Medford School Committee was called to order by Mayor Burke at 7:10 PM. Ms. Kreatz called the roll for attendance

Roll Call - 7 present – 0 absent

Motion to approve minutes of October 15, 2018, by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruseau. Motion passes.

Motion for approval of Bills/Transfers of Funds...

Ms. DiBenedetto - I have two questions on page 7 – SPED - what are pro development expenses? Ms. Patterson - They are contracted services based on special education but I do not what was delivered. I can find out and get back to you. On page 5 – Rydell All American Officials – is it a company? \$9,000? I believe officials are paid under other line items. Ms. Patterson - Although it is under contracted service it relates to refurbishment of athletic equipment.

On the motion to approve by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Ms. Kreatz.

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 motion passes

Motion for approval of Payrolls, by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Mustone

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 motion passes

Report of Secretary – no report

Report of Committees – none

Community participation – none

Report of Superintendent

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I would like to report on events that were held these past two weeks at the Medford Public Schools.

Middlesex District Attorney Marian Ryan presented the Cut It Out Program to cosmetology and health assisting students in Medford Vocational Technical High School. This program taught the students how to notice symptoms of domestic violence and provide information to their clients so they could get help. The Garden Club hosted a lovely harvest party, at Medford High School, serving foods made with items from the high school garden. I thought the School Committee Retreat went very well and I am looking forward to the next session. I have also met with my mentor Karla Baehr. I attended the Mayor's State of the City luncheon which provided me with a wonderful opportunity for me to interact with other department heads. I attended the McGlynn School's ethnic fashion show, which was part of a week of ethnic pride there. Ms. Kreatz also joined me that day. I attended Chief Leo A. Sacco's retirement party. It was a wonderful tribute to a man who has honorably served the Medford Police Department so well. Charlene Douglas, President of the Medford Teachers Union and I did Instructional walks at the Brooks and at the McGlynn, as I continue to build focus on collaborative instruction. We were so happy to cut the ribbon at the new Roberts Playground. I plan to show you a brief video regarding the construction of that playground at our next meeting. I would like to thank the CPC, Roberts PTO, Cheryl Rodriguez and many others. The school yard came out beautiful. As you are aware, an empty bullet casing was found on the Field of Dreams behind the high school, by a concerned citizen. This citizen gave it to our Security Officer Bill Mazaka, who immediately contacted the Medford Police. The police responded immediately. The following morning, Medford Police worked with Cambridge Police and the State Police, each who had dogs, to search the fields and the high traffic use areas of the building. Nothing else was found. I extend my sincere thanks to the Medford Police for their immediate attention to this matter.

Mr. Ruggiero - Was the bullet casing the same millimeter as the one found at the McGlynn School? Mayor Burke - No, what was found at the McGlynn School was a cartridge, not an empty casing.

Motion to accept the Superintendent's Report and place on file by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Kreatz. Motion passes.

Report on Andrews Middle School & Brooks Elementary School - Ms. Caldwell - This is a wonderful example of our students caring for others. The Andrews Middle School's core values are excellence thru responsibility and respect. The Brooks Elementary School is committed to nurturing collaboration, imagination and creative problem solving. The Brooks strives to establish an environment that supports the whole child. Last summer, Orlando Putnam Bagley

who attends the Andrews and his two sisters, Delilah and Isabella, who attend the Brooks, collected enough money in gift cards to provide the Andrews with (90) backpacks and the Brooks with (11) backpacks. Each backpack had materials, school supplies and a hand written note of inspiration. This effort was part of Operation Kind. Mr. Downs, Principal of the Andrews and Ms. Galusi, Principal of the Brooks, were so proud of these students who exemplified responsibility and concern for others. Mr. Downs - Good news like this is nice to note. Some of the inspirational notes stated: You can be anything you want to be. You can do anything. You are amazing. Be kind, be great and be you. Mayor Burke - Wonderful, please come forward as we have citations for each of you. We are so proud to recognize these students. You are being kind and a global citizen, just like the CCSR students who are in our audience tonight.

Motion to accept this report and place on file by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Mustone. Motion passes.

Report on the MAssJas Symposium, Medford High School Senior Shubhecchha Dhaurali - Mr. Cieri - Senior Shubhecchha presented her science project, entitled: "Optical Monitoring of Muscle Hemodynamics in Humans After Exercise" at the Massachusetts Junior Academy of Science Fall Symposium at MIT. Shubhecchha placed second in her panel and has been selected for abstract submission to the AAAS/AJAS 2018 Meeting being held in Washington, DC. Quite an honor for her. However there is a cost for attendance. In the past, we have had students attend this meeting, but we had a grant that helped to pay for them to go. I would like to ask how we can work together to address this question for Shubhecchha to attend. Mayor Burke - I saw you at Science Fair. I have reached out to a corporation that might be able to assist you and I am waiting to hear back. We will find a way! Ms. Van der Kloot - I would like to make a motion, that if corporate sponsorship doesn't work out, can the Medford Public Schools cover her expenses? Ms. DiBenedetto - I'll second the the motion Paulette, to support our outstanding students. Mayor Burke - Prior to the roll call vote, I would like to ask Shubhecchha to come forward and receive a citation. Congratulations on your amazing accomplishment. Shubhecchha - I was inspired to put together this scientific abstract after visiting my home country of Nepal. During that time, I saw how my grandparents had to figure out how to get their diabetes medication. Basic medication was an effort for them to obtain. With the assistance of resources at Tufts University, and research that I did on my own, I want to give people a second chance at life.

Mayor Burke - On the motion to provide funding for this conference via the Medford Public School.

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 motion passes

Mayor Burke – congratulations, wonderful job

Mr. Trotta - the Center for Citizenship & Social Responsibility Program Director – I would like to thank the Superintendent, the Mayor and the School Committee for all of their support. I would like to note that CCSR and Mayor Burke will be hosting a Walk for Veterans this Sunday at City Hall. There is no fee, just requesting a donation. It is a 2.5 mile walk. There will be a reception immediately following at Carroll's Restaurant. With support of the Boston Foundation and the Krystle Campbell Betterment Project we will also be able to conduct projects in Krystle's name

I have provided you with a 104 page report, I'll only read 65 of them ... kidding! CCSR provides students with the foundation to be creative and the encouragement for them to do amazing positive things. This year, CCSR's goal is to expand from K-12. It is a student driven organization that engages all students from all backgrounds. We plan to focus on K-5 next year. I have spent over 40 years in education, and I always felt something was missing. This is it. CCSR creates leaders, and advocates for compassion and kindness. In light of all the terrible national and worldwide tragedies, we strongly believe teaching children and adolescents how to be empathetic leaders and understand the plight of others are imperative to prevent such tragedies from happening again. Burlington is replicating this model, and Lynn and Wakefield are also interested. Mayor Burke – Thank you. An amazing job! Mr. Skorker – Project Director – Thank you for having us. This is my 4th year of CCSR. When I began 4 years ago, I had (18) students. This year, we have over 200 students in grades 8-12. At Medford High, we have 125 students enrolled this year. Jasper Su is a project manager. We attended Mr. Cummings event. Sen Jehlen came to our class and spoke about the importance of civic engagement. They are talking about this program in Marshfield! We met on Oct 29th, to talk about the roles of those in K-5 along with ideas for projects. Anyone in Medford district can now participate. We will send MHS CCSR to the other schools to get the K-8 students excited about it. Ms. Van der Kloot - It was so great to see you all at Mr. Cummings event. He's been so generous to CCSR and I was grateful that so many of you were in attendance. Thank you to all. Ms. DiBenedetto - What about CCSR at the Roberts? I am very appreciative of the empathy, and the whole child – that CCSR speaks about. CCSR teaches the importance of serving the community and what joy it can bring. Very inspiring. Mr. Skorker - Last year, the Roberts didn't have an advisor, but this year, we do have an advisor in every school. Mr. Ruggiero – When do you meet? Mr. Skorker - Every other week – (60) groups this year, so lots of checking in. We have a great passion out there. The following students would like to discuss some of their projects; Dorotea Belotte & Nicole Chin are juniors - We decided to help the victims of the Merrimack gas explosions . We conducted a disaster relief donation drive for (1) week. We collected over \$2,000 in checks and other donation. My parents rented a truck and with Mr. Skorker, we all drove the donations off in Lawrence. We have learned how to be good citizens by being members of CCSR. We want to bring about change. CCSR allows us to address problems. It gives young people a voice and teaches us to become positive leaders. It gives us a chance to

show what we are passionate about. Samuel Cluggish, Stefan Langshur are sophomores and they decided to clean up MacDonald Park. We noticed how messy the boat dock launch was when we went by as members of cross country. There was a lot of trash, so we decided to clean it up. We found out a lot more trash than we thought! We wanted to get it looking nice. CCSR has allowed us to do things like this...to help the community. It's the main goal of CCSR I feel like without CCSR Medford would be so different. It gives us all a sense of citizenship

Mayor Burke - We are all very proud of you. So many students working on multiple projects. You are our future leaders. Congratulations! Jasper Su –I just wanted to add that CCSR is just a fabulous program. I have seen so many amazing projects, all student led. We have amazing advisors who allow us to follow our passions. Ms. Van der Kloot - I can't make the Walk, but please accept this donation.

Mayor Burke - Motion to accept this report and place it on file? Motion accepted

Report on the 2018 MHS/MVTHS College Fair – Ms. Jensen - The College Fair was held on October 24th. There were (99) public and private colleges & universities, community colleges, military branches and support programs present. We host it yearly in the gym. It is very successful & /well attended. The surrounding Medford community attends as not all schools host college fairs. In conjunction with the College Fair, Jan Hollenbeck and Charlotte Heim, of the MHS Special Education Department, hosted a parent/student presentation, "Transition to College for Students with IEPs and 504 Accommodation Plans", as one component of the Medford Public Schools Transition Forum series. This was the 10th year this was offered along with the college fair. Newbury College had a disability services coordinator, explain about supports available for special education students. Ms. Mustone - on Wednesday/November 7th, at the Danversport Yacht Club - all military colleges will be there. Ms. DiBenedetto – What time was IEP's presentation? Ms. Jensen - 5:30 pm and they still were able to make the college fair. Mr. Ruseau - What's the process for colleges to get on to this list? Ms. Jensen - We use the list from the previous year, as well as, see what other colleges our students are interested in and we reach out to them. For example, a number of southwest colleges try to get here. Mr. Ruseau - What is our capacity? Ms. Jensen - We could probably squeeze (200), but parking might become an issue. Also Wednesday/November 7th, is Financial Aid Night.

Mayor Burke motion to accept this report and place on file. Motion passes.

Report on Elementary Highlights - Ms. Caldwell

McGlynn School - hosted Ethnic Pride Week. The Columbus School hosted the 13th Annual Read for the Record with this year's book, Maybe Something Beautiful. The Roberts School hosted a fun family STEM night. The Brooks School - offers many community events throughout the year. The arts are a central component and they believe in educating the whole child. The annual Fall Fest was held on September 23rd. It was a wonderful community event. In the future, we will feature the McGlynn and Andrews Middle Schools.

Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Don't forget your Title One Program that is being held tonight. Ms. Caldwell - Oh yes. Michele Bissell organized it tonight. It's called Bingo for Books. We provide pizza and play bingo to celebrate National Literacy Month. Prizes are books. Over 55 families attend.

Mayor Burke - Motion to accept this report and place on file. Motion passes

New Business ...

Mayor Burke - I would like to offer our condolences to the families of those lost at the terrible attack at the Pittsburgh Temple, as well as, the first responders who responded that day. As we rise to also remember in a moment of silence the memory of Jack Forcier, Michael Cowdrey, Joseph Luongo, and Harvey Howell.

Motion to adjourn – by Ms. Van der Kloot

Mayor Burke - So moved –Meeting adjourned at 8:05 PM